



REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS

Strategic **Landforce Program / Business Line Branding & Organizational Web-Design**

RFP issued	September 8th, 2026
Questions due	September 23rd, 2026
Proposals due	October 7th, 2026
Anticipated project period	November 2nd, 2026 to March 31st, 2027
Lead consultant budget	\$40,000 (for proposals in excess of this amount, please suggest a phased approach since active fundraising is ongoing.)
Submission contact	Elijah Johnson, elijah@landforcepgh.org

1. Invitation and Project Summary

Landforce invites proposals from qualified branding and website strategy, design, and development firms or consultant teams to lead a multi-phase, organization-wide brand development and website redesign process.

Landforce is an employment social enterprise nonprofit that connects workforce development with environmental work. Through paid training and transitional employment, participants build skills and experience while working within our two social enterprises: Land Stewardship and Responsible Wood Production.

The first phase of this project will help us clarify how Workforce Development, Land Stewardship, and Responsible Wood Production fit together within the Landforce identity. Building upon our existing brand, the selected partner will help us determine how each part should be described, imaged, whether the parts need to be renamed, and whether (and how) any of this impacts our social channels. Once these decisions are made, this phase will include developing any naming, visual identity systems, and priority physical collateral, including signage and sales-related visuals, needed to put that brand architecture into practice.

Once that work is complete, the project will move into an organization-wide website redesign. The new website must clearly communicate how Landforce's different parts connect while allowing our varied audiences to quickly find the information they need and take action.

The Central Challenge

Landforce's work is deeply interconnected, but it is not always easy to communicate as a coherent whole. Workforce Development is central to everything we do, while Land Stewardship and Responsible Wood Production provide distinct forms of paid transitional employment, environmental impact, services, and earned revenue. Each part has its own audiences, activities, and communications needs, yet all three are expressions of the same Landforce mission. The central branding challenge is to make these relationships clear: determining what should remain unified, what may benefit from a re-envisioned name or visual expression, and how the individual parts can be distinguished while, crucially, maintaining a unified identity.

Once the branding question is answered and designed, including visual and physical collateral for products and services, we can then turn our attention to the website and social media channels.

The website must translate brand architecture into a clear and intuitive experience for people arriving with very different goals. A prospective Crew Member or referral partner should be able to understand Landforce's employment opportunities and how to apply. A customer should be able to purchase lumber, inquire about biochar or ground crew services, or donate logs. A municipality, public agency, nonprofit, or private client should be able to understand and request Land Stewardship services. Employers, donors, funders, and community or corporate partners should each be able to quickly find relevant information and take action. The challenge is to create a website that serves these distinct needs without requiring users to first understand Landforce's internal structure—and without losing the larger story of how employment, environmental work, and social enterprise reinforce one another.

The same challenge extends to Landforce's social media presence. Our channels must communicate the organization's larger mission while also supporting different objectives: recruiting Crew Members, sharing participant and alumni accomplishments, demonstrating environmental impact, promoting Land Stewardship services, marketing RWP products and services, attracting donors and partners, and establishing Landforce as a credible voice in workforce development and environmental work. The selected partner should help us determine how the organization's brand architecture should be expressed across social media—including whether Landforce's different parts should share channels or maintain distinct accounts, how content should be organized and visually differentiated, and how each channel can speak to its intended audiences without creating confusion, duplication, or an unsustainable burden on staff.

2. About Landforce

Vision

Landforce is committed to building a just world, where everyone belongs, lives in a healthy environment and surpasses their greatest dreams.

Mission

We nourish a culture of self-empowerment for people aspiring towards meaningful and stable employment as we protect and improve the environment.

Values and communications approach

Landforce believes in a just and equitable world where our environment and all people are respected and nurtured. We understand that this begins with intentionally establishing an organizational culture that respects people in our fullest diversity. We believe everyone brings pre-existing skills and experience to the table, that we all can learn from each other, and that fully embodying these beliefs can help create a brighter tomorrow for people and the planet.

Our communications should be people-first, strengths-based, respectful, and clear. Crew members are not problems to be solved, but individuals who are working to forge their own paths. Landforce provides paid opportunities, connections, skills, resources, coaching, and a bridge to meaningful employment. The selected partner must be able to work within this framing and help it remain consistent across audiences and lines of business.

Our model

Landforce provides training, workforce development and paid transitional employment for people who have historically been excluded from stable, family-sustaining employment. Participants receive training and then build skills and work experience while completing environmental projects, receive coaching and other support, earn relevant certifications, and connect with employers.

The organization now operates through two connected business lines where workforce readiness skills can be practiced in reality:

- Land Stewardship: crews complete environmental work that improves public spaces and communities, including habitat restoration / invasive plant maintenance, tree planting and care, trail construction and maintenance, green stormwater infrastructure maintenance, vacant lot improvements, and basic carpentry.
- Responsible Wood Production (RWP): Landforce gives fallen and salvaged urban trees a second life through lumber and, as this work develops, biochar, ground crew services, carpentry or related products and services.

Since 2016, Landforce has trained more than 220 people, employed more than 160 people on projects, and completed work in 83 neighborhoods with 55 partners. Participants have completed more than 91,000 hours of stewardship work and more than 34,000 hours of training.

Workforce Development

Workforce Development is integrated throughout the Landforce experience. Crew Members begin with eight weeks of paid training that results in seven industry-recognized certifications and substantial technical and work-readiness skill development. Training continues during paid transitional employment in Land Stewardship or Responsible Wood Production, allowing Crew Members to apply and build their skills in real working environments.

Landforce recognizes that people bring their whole selves to work. Individualized career coaching, support, and immediate feedback loops continue throughout training and employment. The brand must make the depth of this approach visible without presenting Workforce Development as separate from the environmental work through which it occurs.

Land Stewardship

Land Stewardship is Landforce's foundational social enterprise and the work for which the organization is best known. Over the years we have contracted with 55 partners who have grown familiar with our crews, work ethic, and capabilities in habitat restoration, invasive plant management, tree planting and care, trails, green stormwater infrastructure, vacant-land improvements, and related work. The work has enabled nearly 200 people to contribute towards their futures and their communities in meaningful ways.

As Landforce enters its second decade and considers expanded project types, the brand process should preserve the trust associated with Landforce while sharpening how Land Stewardship's services, quality, environmental accomplishments, and future direction are presented.

Responsible Wood Production and The Mill

Responsible Wood Production grew from Landforce's exploration of a second social-enterprise business line. In October 2025, Landforce opened The Mill, a 10,000-square-foot facility, in Pittsburgh's East End. RWP creates training and employment opportunities while giving fallen urban trees a second life through kiln-dried lumber and, as the enterprise develops, biochar, ground crew services, and related products or services.

RWP is still establishing its name, market presence, operations, products, services, and customer experience. The brand process must clarify its relationship to Landforce and the other programs, accommodate future growth, support straightforward commercial transactions, and guide the customer-facing and physical collateral the enterprise requires.

3. Audiences, Needs, and Priority Actions

The selected partner should validate and refine the following audience framework during discovery. Landforce does not assume every audience requires a separate website section or navigation label; the firm should recommend the clearest user-centered structure.

Area	Audience / User	Likely Need or Action
Workforce Development	Prospective Crew Members	Understand paid training and employment, eligibility, certifications, supports, timing, and how to apply.
Workforce Development	Referral and workforce partners	Understand program fit, pathways, referral timing and process, and whom to contact.
Workforce Development	Employers	Understand participant preparation and how to recruit, provide career exposure, or partner with Landforce.
Land Stewardship	Current and prospective clients	Understand capabilities, experience, project types, service area, and how to request or continue work.
Land Stewardship	Public, nonprofit, and community partners	View project outcomes and explore opportunities to plan, implement, or expand environmental work.
Responsible Wood Production	Log suppliers and partners	Understand accepted material, delivery or collection, and how to donate logs or establish a supply relationship.
Responsible Wood Production	Customers and service clients	Find lumber, biochar, ground crew, and other product or service information; inquire, obtain a quote, reserve, or purchase. (This will require being able to provide daily inventory updates and more casual updates on materials in process.)
Organization-wide	Volunteers	Understand individual and group opportunities and how to participate.
Organization-wide	Corporate partners	Explore hiring, contracting, purchasing, sponsorship, giving, and employee-volunteer opportunities.
Organization-wide	Donors, funders, and public partners	Understand Landforce's integrated model, results, needs, and opportunities for investment.
Organization-wide	Media and the general public	Quickly understand Landforce, find credible facts and stories, and contact the organization.
Organization-wide	Calendar	Quickly recognize open recruitments, planting / pruning seasons, training cohorts, etc.
Organization-wide	Staff	Update content and data, manage inquiries, and understand site performance.

4. Project Goals and Measures of Success

During discovery, the selected partner will establish realistic measures of success and baseline data where available. At minimum, the project should:

1. Clarify how Workforce Development, Land Stewardship, and Responsible Wood Production work together within one coherent Landforce story.
2. Establish and document an organization-wide brand architecture, including any naming, messaging, visual identity, and degree of differentiation needed for each part.
3. Translate the approved architecture into practical, maintainable collateral, including uniforms, signage, product displays, vehicle decals, etc, as well as into a sustainable approach to social media.
4. Create intuitive website pathways and calls to action for Landforce's varied audiences without requiring users to understand its internal structure.
5. Deliver an accessible, secure, mobile-responsive, and staff-maintainable website that supports required forms, integrations, services, products, and frequently changing content.
6. Present Landforce's workforce and environmental outcomes credibly and establish analytics for applications, inquiries, engagement, sales-related actions, and donations.

5. Scope of Work

Landforce anticipates that the project will proceed in two broad phases. The first will establish an organization-wide brand architecture and translate it into priority physical and digital applications. The second will use that work to guide the redesign and development of Landforce's website. Respondents may propose refinements to this sequence, but proposals should address every required workstream and clearly identify exclusions, assumptions, dependencies, optional services, and third-party costs.

A. Discovery, Research, and Alignment

- Conduct a kickoff and review available organizational, programmatic, brand, communications, website, social media, photography, analytics, and planning materials.
- Develop a project plan identifying phases, milestones, decision points, participant roles, Landforce staff time requirements, and approval processes.
- Facilitate a practical stakeholder-engagement process that includes leadership and staff representing Workforce Development, Land Stewardship, Responsible Wood Production, fundraising and communications, and operations.
- Include the perspectives of Crew Members, alumni, board members, and priority external audiences in a respectful process; recommend the appropriate participants, methods, scale, and compensation.
- Gather input from representative external audiences, which may include prospective Crew Members, referral partners, employers, Land Stewardship clients and project partners, RWP customers and suppliers, volunteers, corporate partners, donors, funders, and community partners.
- Audit Landforce's current brand and communications materials to identify existing strengths, sources of recognition and trust, inconsistencies, gaps, and opportunities for improvement.
- Audit the current website, including content, information architecture, analytics, search performance, accessibility, technology, integrations, forms, governance, and staff-maintenance requirements.
- Assess Landforce's current social media channels, audiences, content, visual consistency, performance, and staff capacity, including how Workforce Development, Land Stewardship, and RWP are currently represented.
- Review relevant examples from workforce development, environmental services, social enterprise, urban wood, retail, and other applicable fields to identify useful conventions, gaps, and opportunities.
- Validate and prioritize Landforce's audiences, their needs, the actions they should be able to take, and the messages and evidence most relevant to each.
- Identify organizational or operational decisions that must be resolved for the brand, website, and social media channels to function effectively.

B. Organization-Wide Brand Strategy and Architecture

The selected partner must help Landforce determine how Workforce Development, Land Stewardship, and Responsible Wood Production should be understood and represented within the larger Landforce identity. The process should build upon the recognition and trust Landforce has already established rather than beginning with the assumption that the organization or any of its parts requires an entirely new brand.

The process should examine options such as:

- **A unified Landforce brand:** Workforce Development, Land Stewardship, and Responsible Wood Production operate under the Landforce name and visual identity, with language and visual tools that help audiences distinguish among them.
- **A differentiated or endorsed system:** One or more parts receive a distinct name, descriptor, visual expression, or sub-brand while remaining visibly connected to and endorsed by Landforce.
- **A hybrid architecture:** Different levels of distinction are applied based on the history, audiences, functions, and communications needs of each part. For example, the established Land Stewardship identity may require a different approach from the newer, product- and customer-facing RWP enterprise.

Landforce is not seeking three separate brands simply for the sake of differentiation. (In fact, this is our least preferred outcome unless there is a strong reason that comes from an evidenced-based evaluation of existing brand equity.) The selected partner should recommend the degree of distinction that improves understanding and supports action without

fragmenting the organization, weakening existing recognition, or creating systems that are costly or burdensome to maintain.

The recommendation should consider:

- Audience understanding and the likelihood of confusion.
- The recognition and trust already associated with Landforce and Land Stewardship.
- The central role of Workforce Development across both social enterprises.
- The different audiences, functions, and communications needs of Land Stewardship and RWP.
- The importance of identity for donor and foundation relations.
- The need for RWP to operate credibly in product, retail, and service markets.
- The potential expansion of Land Stewardship and RWP services.
- Mission connection, customer expectations, fundraising needs, staff capacity, and cost.
- Naming, domain, trademark, and other legal considerations.
- The risks of creating unnecessary brand or social media fragmentation.

Required outputs should include:

- A documented organization-wide brand-architecture recommendation and rationale.
- Clear positioning, value propositions, and key messages for Landforce as a whole and for Workforce Development, Land Stewardship, and Responsible Wood Production.
- Recommendations for how each part should be named, described, and visually represented.
- Evaluation of whether existing names should be retained, refined, or changed, with particular attention to the naming of RWP and its retail products.
- Audience testing and preliminary domain, trademark, or naming-conflict screening included in the proposed scope or clearly identified as an additional service.
- A naming and descriptor hierarchy that establishes consistent terminology across the organization.
- A visual identity system appropriate to the approved brand architecture. Depending on the recommendation, this may include updated or new logos or marks, lockups, typography, color, graphic elements, iconography, photography, and voice guidance.
- Guidance for applying the brand architecture across the website, social media, physical spaces, programs, services, products, recruitment, fundraising, volunteering, and partnerships.
- Editable, production-ready brand assets and a practical brand guide that Landforce staff and outside vendors can use.

C. Brand Applications, Collateral, and Social Media

The selected partner should translate the approved brand architecture into a prioritized set of practical applications. Proposals should distinguish among production-ready deliverables, reusable templates, concepts for future implementation, and third-party production or fabrication. The anticipated number range of physical collateral pieces / templates included in the price should be specified in the proposal.

- Organization-wide applications may include presentation and report templates, signage and wayfinding, uniforms and gear, vehicle or equipment identification, volunteer and corporate-partnership materials, and photography guidance.
- Workforce Development applications may include employer or Crew Member recruitment, referral-partner and employer materials, and clear explanations of training, certifications, coaching, transitional employment, and outcomes.
- Land Stewardship applications may include qualifications and service materials, project sheets or case studies, job-site signage, and visual presentation of environmental accomplishments.
- RWP applications may include Mill signage, product labels and packaging, merchandise, retail or showroom materials, and marketing materials supporting front end suppliers (tree service / home owners / municipalities), lumber, biochar, ground crew services, and future offerings.
- Social media work should recommend channel structure, content organization, visual conventions, cross-promotion, calls to action, and reusable templates that staff can sustain. Ongoing social media management is not assumed.

- Respondents must identify what is included in the base fee and separately price optional printing, fabrication, installation, photography, copywriting, physical build-out, and other third-party work.

D. Website Strategy and Information Architecture

- Recommend how Workforce Development, Land Stewardship, and Responsible Wood Production should be organized and presented within the Landforce website in a manner consistent with the approved brand architecture.
- Determine whether any part of Landforce requires a differentiated website section, subdomain, product catalog, commerce environment, or other distinct digital treatment while preserving a clear connection to the larger organization.
- Create a content inventory and disposition plan identifying what should be retained, revised, consolidated, archived, redirected, or newly created.
- Develop a user-centered sitemap, navigation system, taxonomy, page hierarchy, and search or filtering approach, as needed.
- Create user journeys for priority audiences and actions, including Crew Member applications, referrals, employer engagement, Land Stewardship service inquiries, RWP purchases and inquiries, log donations, volunteering, corporate partnerships, financial contributions, and general contact.
- Test the proposed information architecture and priority pathways with representative users.
- Develop wireframes or prototypes for key page types and user journeys before visual design begins.
- Recommend content governance, ownership, review cycles, and workflows that fit Landforce's staff capacity.
- Identify how frequently changing information—such as recruitment cycles, project opportunities, volunteer activities, products, inventory, operating hours, and service availability—will be managed.

E. Content Strategy, Writing, Photography, and Migration

- Develop a website content strategy and page-level content plan grounded in audience needs and Landforce's people-first, strengths-based voice.
- Establish a messaging hierarchy that explains how Workforce Development, Land Stewardship, and RWP fit together while allowing users to complete direct programmatic, service, purchasing, partnership, and donation-related actions efficiently.
- Write, edit, or substantially rewrite agreed-upon priority pages.
- Identify which information and source materials Landforce must provide and use interviews, structured worksheets, or other editorial methods to reduce the burden on staff.
- Develop an approach to Crew Member and alumni stories, Land Stewardship project case studies, RWP products and environmental outcomes, volunteer and partner stories, impact data, photography, video, and consent.
- Assume that Landforce's existing image library will not provide all of the high-quality photography required for the redesigned website and brand applications.
- Propose and price an approach to professional photography that represents the full organization, including Crew Members and staff, training and career coaching, Land Stewardship projects, The Mill, materials and products, customers or partners, and other priority subjects.
- Identify the proposed number and type of photography sessions, creative direction, image ownership and usage rights, editing, consent practices, scheduling requirements, and Landforce responsibilities.
- Migrate approved content and media, including metadata, internal and external links, redirects, and accessible alternative text.
- Provide a plan for maintaining content that changes frequently.

The selected partner will be responsible for developing the content strategy; writing, editing, or substantially revising agreed-upon priority pages; coordinating professional photography; and entering approved content into the new website. Landforce will provide source information, existing materials, access to staff and other participants for interviews and photography, and timely review of drafts. Landforce will remain responsible for verifying organizational data, program information, impact metrics, and other factual claims and for providing final content approval. Respondents should state their assumptions regarding the number of pages and assets included in their proposed fee and describe how additional content would be priced.

F. Visual and Interaction Design

- Create a cohesive organization-wide digital design system based on the approved brand architecture.
- Design responsive page templates and reusable components for priority content, stories, data, services, products, and transactions.
- Establish sufficient visual distinction among Workforce Development, Land Stewardship, and RWP to support understanding without making the website feel like three unrelated organizations.
- Ensure that the experience is welcoming and accessible to prospective Crew Members and community users while remaining credible to clients, customers, employers, funders, institutional partners, volunteers, and corporate partners.
- Balance photography and content related to people, training, environmental projects, materials, products, and physical spaces so that no single part of Landforce overwhelms the larger organizational story.
- Design clear and prominent calls to action appropriate to different audiences and user journeys.
- Provide a component library or comparable design documentation sufficient for consistent future use.

G. Website Development and Functional Requirements

The selected partner should recommend a platform and technical architecture suited to Landforce's requirements, budget, and staff capacity. Landforce currently uses WordPress but is open to a well-supported alternative. The recommendation must address total cost, ease of use, accessibility, security, portability, scalability, and vendor dependence. Prioritize staff capacity in making recommendations.

- Provide a responsive, staff-manageable CMS targeting WCAG 2.2 Level AA and incorporating accepted practices for search optimization, analytics, performance, security, backups, updates, and staging.
- Support secure, appropriately routed forms and priority actions including applications, referrals, employer and service inquiries, volunteering, corporate partnerships, donations, log donations, products or inventory, events, and contact.
- Maintain the current Salesforce and Mailchimp form functions and integrations or recommend an alternative with clear implications for data flow, staff workflow, migration, privacy, cost, and compatibility.
- Create a staff-maintainable impact dashboard or comparable feature presenting selected workforce and environmental measures. Explore an RWP carbon-retention display using transparent methodology, units, assumptions, dates, and update procedures.
- Evaluate RWP's sales and inventory needs and recommend a scalable catalog, inquiry, reservation, quote, or commerce approach. Price advanced commerce functions separately.
- Inventory the current website infrastructure and recommend which hosting, platforms, plugins, forms, and integrations should be retained, replaced, consolidated, or reconfigured.
- Assess privacy, security, data retention, consent, and multilingual needs, particularly for forms collecting sensitive applicant or referral information; identify decisions requiring legal review.
- Preserve Landforce's ownership and administrative control of its domain, content, data, accounts, source and design files, and credentials.
- Develop an SEO strategy supporting national visibility for Landforce's model and local discoverability for Land Stewardship and RWP products and services.
- Evaluate whether paid search, including the Google Ad Grant, could cost-effectively increase qualified traffic and conversions, clearly distinguishing paid-search results from organic SEO performance.

H. Testing, Launch, Training, and Support

- Develop and execute a quality-assurance plan covering current browsers and devices, forms and integrations, accessibility, performance, content, analytics, redirects, and security.
- Conduct usability testing with representative users at appropriate stages and incorporate findings before launch.
- Test priority pathways across Workforce Development, Land Stewardship, RWP, volunteering, corporate engagement, fundraising, and general organizational information.
- Prepare and execute content-migration and launch plans, including redirects, DNS coordination, rollback procedures, and post-launch monitoring.
- Provide role-based staff training, recorded sessions where feasible, and clear documentation for routine editing, publishing, forms, recruitment information, project and service content, products and inventory, impact metrics, analytics, backups, and vendor support.
- Transfer all approved assets, source and design files, documentation, accounts, and administrative credentials to Landforce.

- Provide a defined post-launch warranty period and options for ongoing maintenance, support, enhancements, accessibility monitoring, and response times.

6. Project Approach and Collaboration

Landforce seeks a collaborative partner that can guide decisions, explain tradeoffs plainly, and conduct a rigorous process without placing an unrealistic burden on staff. Proposals should:

- Identify one accountable project lead, the complete team and subcontractors, key decision points, review methods, and realistic Landforce staff-time requirements.
- Explain how stakeholder and user perspectives will be incorporated respectfully and how the brand phase will be approved before directing website design and development.
- Identify dependencies and risks and describe how changes to scope, schedule, assumptions, and costs will be documented and managed.

7. Budget and Schedule

Budget

Budget and Scope Priorities

Landforce currently has \$40,000 available for this engagement. Respondents should propose the strongest integrated base scope that can be completed within that budget while establishing a coherent foundation for future work.

At minimum, the base scope should include:

- Discovery, stakeholder engagement, and assessment of Landforce's existing brand and website.
- An organization-wide brand-architecture recommendation addressing Workforce Development, Land Stewardship, and Responsible Wood Production.
- Core positioning, messaging, naming recommendations, visual identity, and practical brand guidance.
- Website strategy, information architecture, user pathways, and content planning.
- Writing or substantial revision of agreed-upon priority content.
- Design and development of an accessible, secure, mobile-responsive, staff-manageable core website.
- Preservation or appropriate replacement of essential Salesforce and Mailchimp forms and integrations.
- A defined amount of priority photography sufficient to support the core website and brand system.
- Content migration, testing, launch, staff training, and documentation.

Respondents should separately price recommended enhancements that cannot reasonably be included within the available budget. These may include:

- Advanced RWP inventory, reservation, quoting, sales, or commerce functionality.
- Interactive impact dashboards or carbon-retention displays.
- Additional photography, video, copywriting, or content migration beyond the agreed base scope.
- Expanded collateral, social media templates, product labels, packaging, signage, wayfinding, uniforms, merchandise, or other brand applications.
- Printing, fabrication, installation, and other third-party production costs.
- Additional integrations, custom functionality, multilingual content, or ongoing marketing and support.

Landforce welcomes a phased approach when it protects the quality and coherence of the work. Proposals should clearly identify:

- What will be completed within the \$40,000 base budget.
- What is recommended for a subsequent phase.
- The cost and anticipated schedule of each optional component.
- Any dependencies or consequences associated with deferring that work.
- Which later components may become more costly if they are not anticipated during the initial strategy, design, or development process.

Landforce's goal is to complete the funded brand and core website work by March 31, 2027. If the respondent believes that the full base scope cannot responsibly be completed within that period, the proposal should recommend a realistic sequence identifying what will be completed by March 31 and what would follow.

8. Qualifications

The selected firm or coordinated consultant team should demonstrate:

- Experience leading organization-wide brand architecture, naming, messaging, and identity work involving interconnected programs, services, products, or business lines—and building upon an established identity rather than assuming a complete rebrand.
- Ability to translate brand strategy into practical physical, digital, retail, product, recruitment, service, and social media applications, including professional photography.
- Successful strategy, content, information architecture, design, and development of accessible, complex, multi-audience websites.
- Technical capability with maintainable content-management systems, forms, CRM and email integrations, analytics, data visualization, and catalog or commerce functions.
- Relevant nonprofit, social-enterprise, workforce, environmental-service, or product-business experience and a people-first, strengths-based, and equity-centered approach.
- Strong project management, transparent communication, realistic scoping, and a record of delivering systems that organizations with limited internal technical capacity can maintain.

Proposals from consultant teams are welcome but must identify the lead entity, working relationships, responsibilities, and accountability for the complete project.

9. Proposal Requirements

Please submit a concise proposal containing the following information in this order:

1. Understanding of Landforce's integrated model and the project's central brand, communications, and website challenges.
2. Recommended approach to discovery, participation, brand architecture and naming, applications and social media, website strategy, content and photography, design, development, testing, and launch.
3. Preliminary work plan showing phases, milestones, decisions, schedule, Landforce staff requirements, assumptions, and the proposed team and subcontractors.
4. Three relevant case studies collectively demonstrating multi-part brand architecture, translation into physical or digital applications, and a complex multi-audience website; plus two or three comparable client references.
5. Itemized pricing by phase and deliverable, payment schedule, optional and third-party costs, recurring expenses, allowances, hourly rates, and pricing assumptions.
6. Preliminary technology and operational approach, including CMS, hosting, maintenance, accessibility, privacy and security, integrations, analytics, content migration, training, warranty, and ongoing support.
7. Photography and social media approach and pricing, including scope, production, rights, consent, templates, training, and assumptions about materials Landforce will provide.
8. Landforce responsibilities, material exceptions, proprietary tools or constraints, and actual or potential conflicts of interest.

This project is funded in whole or in part by the Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources (DCNR) Bureau of Recreation and Conservation through the Inflation Reduction Act Community Conservation Partnership Program. Additional requirements may be included in the final contract.

- National Policy & Ethical Conduct
 - Debarment and Suspension: Contractors must certify that the firm and its principals are not currently debarred, suspended, or otherwise excluded from participating in federal assistance programs. The Contractor shall provide immediate written notice to the Organization if at any time

prior to or during the performance of this contract the Contractor learns that its certification was erroneous when submitted or has become erroneous by reason of changed circumstances.

- Social & Environmental Protections
 - Equal Employment Opportunity (EEO): All contracts must include the standard EEO clause prohibiting discrimination based on race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, or national origin .
 - Civil Rights & Nondiscrimination: The consultant must operate in accordance with Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964.
- Project Deliverables & Intellectual Property
 - Intangible Property Rights: the Federal Government, the State, and the Funding Recipient reserve a royalty-free, non-exclusive, and irrevocable license to reproduce, publish, copy, or otherwise use, and to authorize others to use, for Federal or public purposes: (a) The copyright in any work developed under this contract; and (b) Any rights of copyright to which the Contractor purchases ownership with federal grant support.

10. Evaluation and Selection

Landforce anticipates evaluating proposals according to the following criteria:

Criterion	Weight
Understanding of Landforce's integrated model and the project's strategic challenges	15%
Strength of organization-wide brand architecture, naming, applications, and social media approach	20%
Strength of website strategy, content, design, technology, accessibility, and launch approach	20%
Relevant experience, quality of comparable work, and capabilities of the proposed team	15%
People-first, equitable, accessible, and participatory approach	10%
Project management, capacity, schedule, collaboration, and risk management	10%
Budget clarity, feasibility, and overall value	10%
Total	100%

Landforce will invite a shortlist of respondents to participate in an interview or working conversation. Landforce may also request clarifications, check references, negotiate scope and cost, or decline all proposals. The contract will be awarded to the vendor whose proposal represents the best overall value. While cost is a significant factor, the lowest-priced bid will not necessarily be selected if it fails to meet key technical, operational, or quality standards.

Finalists will not be asked to produce unpaid speculative design work. Any requested exercise will be limited to discussion of the respondent's process, experience, and approach unless Landforce establishes and communicates compensation in advance.

11. Procurement Schedule

Milestone	Date
RFP issued	September 8th, 2026
Deadline for written questions	September 23rd, 2026

Milestone	Date
Responses to questions distributed	September 30th, 2026
Proposals due	October 7th, 2026
Initial proposal review	October 7th to 20th, 2026
Finalist interviews	October 23rd and October 26th, 2026
Reference checks and scope clarification	October 26th to October 29th, 2026
Notice of selection	October 30th, 2026
Anticipated kickoff	November 1st, 2026
Target completion of brand-development phase	January 31, 2027
Target website launch	March 31, 2027

12. Submission Instructions and Contact

Proposals must be submitted electronically to:

Elijah Johnson
Communications Manager
Landforce
elijah@landforcepgh.org

Proposal deadline: October 7th, 2026

Email subject line: Landforce Brand and Website RFP Proposal – [RESPONDENT NAME]

Proposals should be submitted as a single PDF unless otherwise approved in advance. Respondents are responsible for confirming successful delivery.

Written questions must be submitted to Elijah Johnson by September 23rd, 2026. Landforce will distribute responses to submitted questions by September 30th, 2026 so that all interested respondents have access to the same information. Respondents should not contact other Landforce staff, board members, Crew Members, clients, or partners regarding this RFP unless Landforce provides authorization. All submission deadlines are 11:59 pm Eastern Time.

Proposals received after the stated deadline may be rejected.

Appendix A. Vendor Pricing Schedule

We would appreciate respondents following the format below so that Landforce can compare costs across proposals. Add rows or explanatory notes where necessary. Do not combine recurring expenses with one-time project fees.

Cost Category	Base Fee	Optional or Allowance	Recurring Cost	Assumptions and Exclusions
Discovery, research, and stakeholder engagement	\$	\$	\$	
Brand architecture, naming, identity, and brand guide	\$	\$	\$	
Collateral, physical applications, and social media	\$	\$	\$	
Website strategy, content, migration, and photography	\$	\$	\$	
Website design, development, and CMS	\$	\$	\$	
Forms, integrations, impact dashboard, and RWP catalog/commerce	\$	\$	\$	
Testing, launch, training, and documentation	\$	\$	\$	
Hosting, licenses, maintenance, and post-launch support	\$	\$	\$	
Travel, incentives, fabrication, installation, and other expenses	\$	\$	\$	
Total	\$	\$	\$	